



Monkeys and Apes



“Good morning class, today our lesson is going to be about monkeys and apes,” said the teacher, Miss Smith. “Does anyone know the difference between monkeys and apes?” she said.

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Sam puts up her hand. “A monkey is small and an ape is big,” said Sam. “I think you are on the right track,” said Miss Smith. “Anyone else?” she asks. The pupils shrug their shoulders.

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“To start with, the best way to tell the difference between a monkey and an ape is by the tail. A monkey has a tail. An ape does not have a tail. Also, monkeys are often smaller and apes are often larger with a broad chest,” said Miss Smith.

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“Can anyone tell me what a primate is?” the teacher asks. Ted puts up his hand. “A primate is a monkey?” said Ted. “Yes. In zoology, monkeys and apes are in the group of mammals called primates. Humans are in this primate group too,” she said.

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“Who is smarter? Monkeys or apes?” asks Sam. “Apes are considered more intelligent than monkeys. Most species of apes make use of tools and have a higher ability to communicate with language through sounds and gestures,” said Miss Smith.

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“Can anyone give me some examples of apes?” said Miss Smith. “I know! Chimpanzees and gorillas,” said Sam. “And monkeys?” said Miss Smith. “I know, I know! Spider and howler monkeys,” said Ted.

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“Which is cuter? Monkeys or apes?” asks Miss Smith. Ted put up his hand. “Miss Smith, you are asking our opinion now. Not facts from a book,” said Ted. Miss Smith smiled. “I’m glad you kids are paying attention today,” she said.

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